

Did You Know?

Sunflowers can help clean up radioactive waste. This and other random facts at: <http://dgit.in/1EdLZiF>

**3-D Printing clothes**

This prototype 3-D printers can print seamless fabric. Check it out: <http://dgit.in/1B7mHTh>



Build your own 3D printer; it's not rocket science

3D printers aren't affordable yet, so wouldn't that motivate you to actually build one?

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Contrary to the hilarious misconception many seem to harbour, a 3D printer is not a device that produces 3D images on printing paper which you have to look at using 3D glasses! No, it is a machine which takes 3D model files (which you can create using 3D CAD software or download from the Internet), and converts them

into real, physical objects made out of plastic. Thanks to this device, your imagination is literally turned into reality, all in a matter of a few hours, while you're sitting at home.

In the last few years, 3D printing has been gaining a lot of popularity worldwide, and has now gradually started making its presence felt in India as well.

It all started around the year 2007, when patents for 3D printers began to expire, post which a string of replicas were produced by hackers who had fig-

ured out the technique. The first major project which attempted to recreate the prototype was the 'RepRap' (<http://reprap.org/>), which stands for 'Replicating Rapid Prototyping'. It involved building a machine which could make another copy of itself.

For the longest time, there have been no avenues to buy 3D printers in India. However, there are several vendors in the market selling 3D printer components. And today, we have reached a stage where fashioning these printers